

TECH-COM DSC-524X PLUS	TECH-COM DSC-601
	
Rs 5,250	Rs 4,975
Good features and performance	Lightweight
Average macro performance	No focus or optical zoom
56.12	51.18
20.40	16.90
19.29	16.95
16.42	17.33
2560 x 1920	2864 x 2160
5.3 MP	6.18 MP
3x	NA
5x	5x
100 - 400	100 - 400
8 - 1/1000	8-1/1000
6	6
10 cm	20 cm
Y	Y
N	N
2	2
Y / N	Y / N
2.4"	2"
110,000	115,000
9.99 x 5.54 x 3.52	9.55 x 5.22 x 2.97
140 gm	90 gm
Y	Y
SD/MMC	SD/MMC
32 MB	32 MB
Y / 640 x 480	Y / 640 x 480
Y	Y
N	N
AA	AA
N	N
N	N
N	N
Y	Y
USB-A/V cable, Pouch, Hand-strap	USB-A/V cable, Pouch, Hand-strap
5.21	5.00
5.00	4.75
3.63	2.75
4.75	3.42
4.75	4.75
4.75	4.50

checks the image for blur once the photo has been shot, and asks you whether you still want to save the photo. So if you're on a clicking spree, you might have to keep saying "yes" every time. Bonus or irritant?

Performance

We got some pretty impressive shots from the Kodak V803. The crispness throughout the images was great; the macro shots were very easy to focus and the results were brilliant as well. The colours were a tiny bit on

How We Tested

We conducted a barrage of tests on the cameras with the main focus being quality. The primary test scene consisted of objects of a spectrum of colours and patterns. As you can see from the photograph, we had everything from bottles and cans to colour pencils. All were arranged on a table with a thunder-grey sheet on top. We used daylight simulation lights to illuminate the scene. The room was darkened to keep the conditions even. We placed the tripod at a suitable distance, and took the shots using a timer to provide more or less uniform situations for all the cameras. We carried out all the tests at the highest resolution possible, and the quality set to Best. We conducted all the tests—except the macro and portrait—at Auto settings.

To compare the photos, we used the Nikon D200 as a reference for higher-end cameras.



Here's a look at our reference shot

Quality

We conducted the quality test with the lights on; captured the test photo with the flash turned off. We examined and compared fine details. Some of these details were small text on a motherboard, as well as CPU socket pins and PCI slot patterns. Other things observed were the texture of the blue cloth and the text on the globe. Finer aspects included how well the specular effect on the bottles and the globe would turn out in the photos. There was also emphasis laid on the shadows on the motherboard panel and the details in the darker areas.

Macro

The macro shots were taken with the macro mode enabled. It involved us taking the closest possible shots to the colour pencils. We looked at the ability of the camera to focus properly and the amount of depth of field blur we could get.

Flash

For the flash test, we turned off all the lights and had the camera focus on the scene with whatever little ambient light there was. This shot helped us gauge how intense the flash was and how much the colours and shades degraded because of it.

Outdoors

The outdoor shots were taken at some 13 different locations around our office premises. They were mostly photos of plants and of the hills in the background. We used different zoom settings to shoot distant areas. Macro shots were taken of plants and some of metal piping.

Portrait

We shot a photo of an individual against daylight. This test photo was used to rate how well skin tones and gradients were represented.

Video

We took all our videos at the best resolutions supported. We recorded a short video clip to gauge the quality of the video in terms of crispness and colour. We also considered the resolution and frame rate of the video during the rating process.